

BEST BUY
digit
APRIL 2005

In the 17-inch segment, Samsung SyncMaster 793S was free of any ghosting and streaking when



Acer AF715 (17-inch)

tested with the four slides we ran the monitor through. The Samsung SyncMaster 793MB was equally impressive, but there was slight ghosting trailing of a bright bar on a dark background. The NEC MultiSync FE791SB, however, did not manage the impressive score it did in the other tests. Ghosting was prominent at different intensities, especially with white and yellow over a grey background.

In the 19-inch category, the HCL HCM985RFM and the Samsung 957MB were relatively free from the ghosting effect. Here again, the NEC MultiSync FP912SB returned poor results.

The White and Black Level is another problem visible at the edges' areas of various intensities.

Again, office applications such as Word, Excel and PowerPoint are good examples where this 'level shift' is visible. In Word, the white area where words are typed, and the adjacent grey background makes for a white-level shift in the form of a visible tinge of colour. This makes the edges blurry. Of course, this is just an example, and is a minor problem with office applications, but for graphics professionals it means inaccuracy. They need displays that show crisp images that match the printouts perfectly.

In both the 17-inch and the 19-inch categories, there was very little level shift visible in the monitors. We could see some red and blue tinges, which were not very prominent. The tinges were visible only if scrutinised.

Text Colour

You often come across coloured text on a coloured background—especially in Web pages. The crispness of coloured text suffers on colour backgrounds. In some cases, the edges will be blurred, or the text appears thick or thin. Red text on blue will appear thick, whereas red text on yellow will

appear thin. This happens because the brighter colours bleed into darker colours.

Among the 17-inch monitors, the Philips 107 C6 gave good results, making it a good choice for Web designers and surfers. The Microtek Flatvision 43F1 suffered in this test. The cyan text on a red background was full of blue tinges, and red text appeared very thin on a yellow background.

In the 19-inch category, the NEC MultiSync FP912SB returned acceptable results. The colours weren't perfect, of course, but they were definitely acceptable.

The Acer AC915 returned below-par results, and left a lot to be desired.

Miscellaneous Tests

We looked for common problems such as the uniformity of the screen, flicker, the reflection

problem and the shadow mask problem. CRT

monitors usually do not display the screen uniformly. Most of the CRT monitors appear brighter at the centre, and get dimmer towards the corners. Flicker is another problem with CRT monitors, and it will persist unless the refresh rate is well above 72 Hz.

BEST BUY
digit
APRIL 2005



Viewsonic E71f (17-inch)

Score Board				
Brand	Model	Basic Specifications	Score (Out of 100)	Price (Rs)
17-inch CRT Monitors				
Acer	AC715	0.27mm, 30 - 72KHz, 1280x1024@60Hz, 110MHz, Shadow Mask, 15.5Kg, 75W	61.88	5495
Acer	AC715	0.25mm, 30 - 98KHz, 1600x1200@75Hz, 200MHz, Shadow Mask, 17Kg, 120W	64.80	6995
BenQ	G776	0.25mm, 30 - 72KHz, 1280x1024@67Hz, 110MHz, Shadow Mask, 16.4Kg, 75W	55.19	8500
BenQ	P776	0.27mm, 30 - 72KHz, 1280x1024@67Hz, 110MHz, Shadow Mask, 15.4Kg, 75W	55.85	9600
BenQ	V773	0.27mm, 30 - 72KHz, 1280x1024@67Hz, 110MHz, Shadow Mask, 15.4Kg, 70W	61.99	6900
HCL	HCM780M	0.27mm, 30 - 70KHz, 1280x1024@60Hz, 110MHz, Shadow Mask, 15.5Kg, 75W	59.85	6300
HCL	HCM785RFM	0.25mm, 30 - 54KHz, 1280x1024@60Hz, 110MHz, Shadow Mask, 16Kg, 90W	54.91	7900
LG	StudioWork 7005	0.27mm, 30 - 70KHz, 1280x1024@60Hz, NA, Shadow Mask, 14.4Kg, 74W	58.97	8000
LG	Flatron E700SH	0.25mm, 30 - 70KHz, 1280x1024@60Hz, 110MHz, Shadow Mask, 16Kg, 74W	51.93	13500
Microtek	FlatVision 43F1	0.28mm, 30 - 70KHz, 1280x1024@60Hz, 110MHz, Shadow Mask, 15.5Kg, 95W	58.67	5700
NEC	MultiSync FE791SB	0.25mm, 30 - 96KHz, 1600x1200@70Hz, NA, Aperture grille, 17Kg, 68W	55.33	17000
Philips	107 C6	0.25mm, 30 - 71KHz, 1280x1024@60Hz, 120MHz, Shadow Mask, 15.8Kg, 68W	55.28	10000
Philips	107 E5	0.27mm, 30 - 71KHz, 1280x1024@60Hz, 120MHz, Shadow Mask, 13.4Kg, 64W	54.34	8500
Samsung	SyncMaster 793MB	0.20(H)mm, 30 - 70KHz, 1280x1024@65Hz, 110MHz, Shadow Mask, 14.2Kg, 80W	59.12	8100
Samsung	SyncMaster 793S	0.23(H)mm, 30 - 70KHz, 1280x1024@65Hz, 110MHz, Shadow Mask, 13.8Kg, 80W	60.69	6400
Samsung	SyncMaster 793DF	0.20(H)mm, 30 - 70KHz, 1280x1024@65Hz, 110MHz, Shadow Mask, 14.3Kg, 80W	59.46	7900
Viewsonic	E71f	0.25mm, 30 - 71KHz, 1280x1024@66Hz, 110MHz, Shadow Mask, 16Kg, 75W	62.39	7500
Viewsonic	E72f+SB	0.25mm, 30 - 72KHz, 1280x1024@60Hz, 110MHz, Shadow Mask, 18.1Kg, 75W	59.89	7600
19-inch CRT Monitors				
Acer	AC915	0.26mm, 30 - 98KHz, 1600x1200@75Hz, 202MHz, Shadow Mask, 18.2Kg, 130W	61.31	13495
HCL	HCM985RFM	0.26mm, 30 - 98KHz, 1600x1200@75Hz, 200MHz, Shadow Mask, 20Kg, 130W	64.17	13100
LG	StudioWork 910	0.26mm, 30 - 85KHz, 1600x1200@65Hz, NA, Shadow Mask, 17.3Kg, 70W	58.32	17000
NEC	MultiSync FP912SB	0.24mm, 30 - 110KHz, 1920x1440@73Hz, 290MHz, Aperture grille, 23.8Kg, 102W	63.83	19000
Philips	109 B6	0.25mm, 30 - 97KHz, 1920x1440, 250MHz, NA, Shadow Mask, 20Kg, 75W	59.14	20000
Philips	109 E5	0.26mm, 30 - 92KHz, 1920x1440@60Hz, 240MHz, Shadow Mask, 17.8Kg, 65W	61.48	17500
Samsung	SyncMaster 957MB	0.20(H)mm, 30 - 96KHz, 1920x1440@64Hz, 250MHz, Shadow Mask, 18.2Kg, 100W	65.53	16500
Samsung	SyncMaster 997DF	0.20(H)mm, 30 - 96KHz, 1920x1440@64Hz, 250MHz, Shadow Mask, 18.2Kg, 100W	66.97	14900
Viewsonic	UltraBrite E90f+	0.25mm, 30 - 86KHz, 1792x1344, 202MHz, Shadow Mask, 22Kg, 100W	62.54	14250

For the complete scoreboard, log on to www.thinkdigit.com